

Mobile app development is one of the hottest areas of interest for any developer. And anyone can be a part of this ecosystem, literally. So what does an app developer need to succeed in the business? **Diksha P Gupta** from the **Open Source For You** team tries to answer that question for you with the help of Binay Tiwari, director, Global Marketing & Product, Vserv.mobi; Dharendra Singh, MD, Trivial Apps; and Sanjay Mohan Dubey, VP, Adodis Technologies.

What tips would you like to give to a new app developer?

Having a strong knowledge of programming languages helps a lot in app development. One can also download some existing source code from the websites that offer free source code for analysis. Developers should focus on the layout of the app, too. In the world of mobile apps, the real estate (screen size) of the device is a crucial part. The space is limited. So placement of the elements on the screen is an important point to work on.

The mobile space is extremely dynamic and you get newer technologies every other day. So one has to keep exploring and stay abreast with the latest mobile technologies. Knowledge of fundamental platforms is very important as it helps in building the basic blocks for any application. Developers should be analytically strong and should be capable of analysing logic.

They need to be aware that increased app downloads will lead to greater revenues. App developers also need to widen their base and reach out to the maximum number of users. As a start, app developers need to first ensure that their app is present on all popular app stores such as GetJar, Vodafone, SlideMe, Mobango, etc. Simultaneously, they can forge a strategic partnership with handset manufacturers so that their apps can be pre-bundled with mobile devices. Developers can also invest in cost-per-download campaigns to enhance the overall efficacy and reach of the app.

How do you see the app ecosystem evolving in the next few years?

Just as we had witnessed a dotcom boom earlier, we are all set to see the app boom now. We have smartphones ranging from less than Rs 5,000 to Rs 45,000, and this variation provides an opportunity to the app developers to reach out to all segments of the market. Also, the improving processors are adding to the growth of high-quality apps. So, I see huge potential in this market in the years to come.

I see the mobile apps ecosystem evolving significantly in the coming years. Apart from individual users, a lot of enterprises will leverage this technology for their day-to-day work. Apps will be a primary mode of transaction, be it business transactions or the operations transactions. As BYOD (bring your own device) picks up, mobile apps in the enterprise space will grow in many ways.

With the mobile becoming the primary screen for the global consumer, the app ecosystem, too, will continue to evolve. Between iOS and Android, close to a 100 billion apps have been downloaded to date. This will continue to increase with the phenomenal rise in smartphone adoption, which is currently growing at approximately 50 per cent, YoY. Apps will continue to become the centre of everyone's lives. The ecosystem will be further driven by the next billion users, who will require apps in regional languages.

How do you see Android growing? Will it continue to grow in the same pace?

Android is poised to grow phenomenally. There are a couple of things about OSs that programmers love and hate. If it is an open source OS, they feel that they can also contribute to it. They can add their own library. But if it is not open source like Apple iPhone and Microsoft Windows Phone, the scope is limited. So, for developers, Android is the platform, provided they are able to make money out of it.

Yes, of course. Android will see the highest growth because of the range of hardware available for the platform. The open source nature of Android is helpful for even the small OEMs to enter the business. It has captured a huge market share already and India is no exception. No matter how many platforms come and go, Android is here to stay.

Yes. The mobile app ecosystem is growing manifold and emerging markets are powering its growth. According to some estimates, the BRIC countries will dominate shipments by 2018 and will account for 33 per cent of the smartphone shipments. If the current trends hold, most of these devices will be powered by Android.